COMPANY NAME

Local Food Service App

Project Vision Document

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Revision History

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1 Introduction

The Project Vision Document details the requirements, features, and goals of the Local Food Service App. Its functionalities are designed to address the needs of stakeholders and target users, with concrete examples provided in the use-case specifications. The document further defines the system's purpose and scope, and highlights key components such as the business opportunities, problem statement, and descriptions of users and stakeholders.

1.1 Purpose

The purpose of this document is to highlight the project's objective, scope and features, creating a shared understanding among all stakeholders. It cultivates transparency between stakeholders and developers by clarifying user needs, thereby making communication more effective and the development process more efficient. By focusing on the business opportunities and the problem statement, the project aims to define clear goals, align them with user expectations, and provide a solid foundation for implementation and measurable outcomes. The document also serves as a reference point throughout the development process and system lifecycle. As a result, this document ensures that the Local Food Service App stays aligned with its core purpose of enabling farmers to sell their products through a broader marketplace, promoting sustainable consumption, and enhancing the overall user experience.

1.2 Scope

The scope of the Local Food Service App defines the features and services that will be delivered as part of the project, as well as those that fall outside the boundaries of this system.

1.2.1 In Scope

The LFCA will enable farmers to access a larger marketplace where they can sell their products, encouraging waste reduction. Users will be able to rate and leave reviews for sellers and goods, promoting fair business practices and providing farmers with opportunities to grow their businesses. By using advanced filters, any person will be able to find products that best cater to their specific needs. To further support waste reduction, local restaurants will be able to post information about their leftovers, allowing users to reserve and pick them up. With features such as creating chat threads and joining or starting communities, users will have the chance to build new connections. The app will also allow users to follow accounts, such as sellers and restaurants, and receive notifications about new posts, deals, and updates, ensuring stronger engagement and timely access to opportunities. Through the ability to track weekly usage of products and ingredients, both users and restaurants will be able to minimize waste by avoiding over-purchasing. The app will also allow users to predict upcoming needs with the help of AI, while a recipe maker will be introduced to maximize the use of available ingredients.

1.2.2 Out of Scope

The LFCA will not extend into areas beyond its primary purpose of connecting local farmers, restaurants, and consumers. International or large-scale logistics, such as nationwide shipping or delivery management, are excluded from the system. Advanced warehouse or supply chain management features will not be provided, as the app focuses only on basic product availability

updates and usage tracking. The app will not integrate with large third-party retailers, supermarkets, or external e-commerce platforms. In addition, the LFCA will not handle financial management tasks like tax calculations, bookkeeping, or accounting support beyond basic payment processing. Delivery logistics, including fleet or driver management, routing, or courier services, will also remain outside the project's scope.

1.3 Definitions, Acronyms, and Abbreviations

Term	Explanation
LFCA	Local Food Service App

1.4 References

Reference File Name	Version	Description
Vision-doc-UTDCS-17-04		Project Vision document - example

This section also contains links to all other places that were referred to in this document. These may include:

- *Web sites*
- *URLs or network locations*
- *Research done for similar products*

Name	Link

2 Positioning

2.1 Business Opportunity

The Local Food Service App presents an opportunity to connect local farmers, restaurants, and consumers within a single digital platform. Farmers often struggle to reach a broad market, while consumers seek fresh, transparent, and locally sourced products. Restaurants also face challenges in managing surplus food and reducing waste. By providing a marketplace for direct sales, waste redistribution and recipe recommendation, LFCA markets itself as a special solution that encourages waste reduction, builds community relationships, and gives farmers the chance to grow their companies independently of large retail intermediaries.

2.2 Problem Statement

The Problem of	Limited market access for local farmers, food waste from restaurants, and lack of transparency in food origins
affects	Farmers, restaurants, NGOs, and consumers
the impact of which is	Lost income opportunities for farmers, unnecessary food waste from businesses, reduced support for community organizations, and limited consumer trust in product origins.
a successful solution would be	A platform that enables farmers to sell directly to a wider customer base, allows restaurants to redistribute leftovers to NGOs, shelters, other customers, provides consumers with easy-to-use filters and transparent product details, and supports community engagement through reviews, subscriptions, and recipe creation

Table 1 Problem Statement

2.3 Product Position Statement

For	Local farmers, restaurants, NGOs, and consumers
Who	Need a reliable way to sell, purchase, and redistribute food while reducing waste and supporting sustainable practices
The Local Food Service App	is a community-driven digital marketplace
That	Provides direct access to a broader market, transparent product information, recipe recommendations, and tools for surplus redistribution
Unlike	Large retail platforms or traditional grocery chains
Our product	Empowers local producers to grow independently, fosters community connections, and promotes sustainability.

Table 2 Product Position Statement

2.4 SWOT Analysis

Strengths	Weaknesses
A unique marketplace and sustainability platform that combines product sales with surplus redistribution	Lack of integrated delivery system may present a challenge for both sellers and consumers
Provides farmers with a marketplace where they can sell directly to a consumer, eliminating the need for a large retail intermediary, making them independent	Limited initial reach compared to large retail chains and e-commerce platforms
Features that build community engagement, such as reviews, community groups and chat threads are included	A need for a reliable and consistent moderation to prevent fraudulent sellers operating, posts with inappropriate content and fake reviews
Opportunities	**Threats**
A rising demand for local, sustainable, ethically sourced products by consumers	Strong competition from established e-commerce platforms and large retail chans
Potential partnership with NGOs, shelters and restaurants, strengthening community food networks	Risk of low engagement from farmers if consumer adoption is slow or vice versa
Provides farmers with an additional income stream and the ability to operate independently, reducing reliance on intermediaries and traditional retail channels.	User reluctance to switch to another app from familiar platforms

3 Stakeholder and User Descriptions

3.1 Market Demographics

The Local Food Service App targets four main groups of users. Local farmers as the primary suppliers, using the platform to sell fresh produce and homemade goods directly to consumers. Consumers who seek access to fresh, locally produced products, taking advantage of transparent product information, filters, and recipe recommendations. Restaurants, using the app both as buyers and as contributors by posting surplus food for redistribution. Finally, NGOs and shelters, leveraging the platform to reserve and collect donated food from restaurants, thereby reducing waste and supporting communities in need.

3.2 Stakeholder Summary

Stakeholder Name	Represents	Role
Local farmers	Local grower or producer selling goods directly	Create product posts, manage sales, respond to reviews, handle consumer to seller communication and track business growth
Consumers	Individuals purchasing goods from the app	Search for products, filter them as they see fit, buy products, leave reviews, engage in chats and follow sellers
Restaurants	Local food businesses	Post leftover food, donate it to NGOs, shelters, consumers, leverage app's features, such as: weekly usage tracking and predictions of upcoming needs
NGOs/Shelters	An organization seeking food donations	Reserve leftovers, manage pickup and provide feedback
Administrator	Platform operator	Review flagged content, take down inappropriate content, maintain platform security
Developers	A group of people working on a technical part of the project	Building the web application itself, implementing the required features

Table 3 Stakeholder Summary

3.3 User Summary

User Name	Description	Responsibilities	Stakeholder
Farmer	Local producer, selling their products directly through the app	Create product posts, update availability, engage in chats with customers	Local Farmers
Customer	Individual consumer, purchasing goods from the farmers or reserving leftovers from restaurants	Create an account, search, filter and buy products, rate and leave reviews about sellers	Consumers
Restaurant	Restaurant staff using the app	Post leftover food for donations, leverage app's features to track weekly usage and make predictions of upcoming needs	Restaurants
NGO/Shelter	Non profit organizations seeking food donations	Reserve leftover food, posted by restaurants, arrange pickups, provide feedback	NGOs/Shelters
Admin	System admin	Take down posts with inappropriate content, detect and prevent fraudulent activity, maintain app's security	Administrator

3.4 User Environment

General users will access LFCA remotely through a web browser on desktop or mobile devices. The LFCA is designed as a web application so no specialized software or hardware is required beyond a stable internet connection.

Administrators will be able to access the app with privileges through the administrator panel, where they will be able to monitor and manage posted content

3.5 Stakeholder profiles

- **Local Farmer**
  - Description: Independent grower or producer selling their fresh homemade goods
  - Type: Active seller, primary supplier.
  - Responsibilities: Create product posts, update availability, engage in chats with customers.
  - Success criteria: Farmers are able to reach a wide audience and grow independently as a business, without relying on intermediaries.
  - Involvement: Be a core supplier, provide feedback about seller tools and usability
- **Consumer**
  - Description: An individual purchasing locally sourced goods from the app
  - Type: Everyday user
  - Responsibilities: Search, filter and buy products, leave reviews, join communities, follow sellers
  - Success criteria: Consumers can easily find products that fit their filters and enjoy the transparent shopping experience
  - Involvement: Participate in testing, provide feedback
- **NGO/Shelter**
  - Description: Non-profit organization seeking food donations
  - Type: Community-focused stakeholder
  - Responsibilities: Reserve leftover foods and arrange pickups
  - Success criteria: NGOs can easily reserve and collect foods, serving the community
  - Involvement: Engage in a donation workflows during testing and maintain partnership post-release
- **Restaurant**
  - Description: Local food business
  - Type: Business stakeholder
  - Responsibilities: Post leftover foods, track weekly usage, use an upcoming needs prediction feature
  - Success criteria: Restaurants reduce food waste, stop overbuying with the help of usage prediction and strengthen the community presence
  - Involvement: Provide feedback during feature development and testing, remain active donors and users post-release
  -
- **Administrator**
  - Description: Platform operator
  - Type: Internal system management
  - Responsibilities: Take down inappropriate content, detect and prevent fraudulent activity, fake posts, reviews etc. Ensure app's security
  - Success criteria: The platform remains safe and trustworthy
  - Involvement: Maintain the app throughout its lifecycle

4 Stakeholder Requirements

ID	Requirement	Stakeholder
SR-001	Ability to create, update, and manage product posts.	Local Farmers
SR-002	Access to a marketplace with an intuitive, user-friendly interface	All stakeholders
SR-003	An ability to create an account and manage filters, preferences and maintain a list of products to avoid	All stakeholders
SR-004	Ability to purchase products directly from sellers.	All stakeholders
SR-005	Ability to leave ratings and reviews for products and sellers.	All stakeholders
SR-006	Option to follow sellers or restaurants and receive notifications about new products or donations.	All stakeholders
SR-007	Ability to reserve restaurant's leftovers and manage pickup schedule	All stakeholders
SR-008	Ability to post leftover food items for donation or pickup.	Restaurants
SR-009	Tools to track ingredient usage and receive AI predictions for future needs.	All stakeholders
SR-010	Tools to verify seller, restaurant, and NGO accounts.	Administrators

ID	Requirement	Stakeholder
SR-011	Ability to moderate and remove inappropriate content or fraudulent reviews.	Administrators

Table 5 Stakeholder Requirements

5 System Features

ID	Feature	Stakeholder Requirement ID
SF-001	Product posting and management feature that allows farmers to create, edit or delete their posts. Also allows them to update availability	SR-001
SF-002	User-friendly marketplace interface that allows farmers, consumers, restaurants, and NGOs to access the platform intuitively, browse listings, and engage with features seamlessly across devices.	SR-002
SF-003	User account system with profile management, filters, preference settings, and an “avoid list” for restricted ingredients or products.	SR-003
SF-004	Integrated checkout and order management system enabling direct purchases from sellers.	SR-004
SF-005	Ratings and review system for products and sellers, including optional written feedback and seller responses.	SR-005

ID	Feature	Stakeholder Requirement ID
SF-006	Follow-and-notify feature allowing users to follow sellers or restaurants and receive notifications for new posts, deals, or donations.	SR-006
SF-007	Reservation and pickup scheduling feature for restaurant leftovers, with notifications and confirmation workflows.	SR-007
SF-008	Restaurant donation posting feature that allows restaurants to post about their leftover food ready for pickup	SR-008
SF-009	Usage tracking and AI-driven prediction feature that allows users to track their weekly usage of products and receive AI-driven usage predictions to forecast ingredient needs and prevent overbuying	SR-009
SF-010	Account verification feature for farmers, restaurants, NGOs including automated checks and manual reviews if needed	SR-010
SF-011	Content moderation tools for administrators to efficiently ensure security of the app	SR-011

Table 6 System Features

6 Assumptions

It is assumed that users, including farmers, restaurants, NGOs, and consumers, will have access to a stable internet connection and a modern browser in order to use the web application. It is expected that stakeholders will be willing to use digital platforms for food donation, purchase, and sale. For the information to be accurate it is assumed that farmers and restaurants update their postings on product availability and leftovers frequently. NGOs and shelters are expected to have the logistical capacity to collect

reserved food within the agreed time frame, while consumers and other users are assumed to provide honest reviews and ratings. It is further assumed that payment processing will be handled securely by a trusted third-party provider, ensuring reliability. The app's success also relies on having a sufficient amount of stakeholders in each group. Finally, AI driven features, such as usage prediction or recipe generation are assumed to depend on accurate input given by users

7 Constraints

The LFCA will be constrained by reliance on a third-party service for secure payment, which limits customization options for transactions. Delivery and logistics also fall outside of the project scope, meaning users will need to independently arrange pickups and distribution. Additionally, compliance with food safety regulations, health standards, and donation practices imposes restrictions on how products and surplus food may be listed, transferred, and monitored within the application.